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Market Briefs Pro

Read less news

Good morning, Pro Briefers!

Earlier in 2025, we reported on the rise of artificial sweeteners and how that Wall Street shift was causing more businesses to use added chemicals in their products.

But a few key things have happened since then:

- Robert F. Kennedy Jr. was named the Head of the Department of Health and Human Services in February.
- President Trump formed the Make America Healthy Again commission through executive order (more on this later) in May.
- In June, Kraft-Heinz (KHC) announced it was taking steps to eliminate all artificial dyes in its foods by 2027.

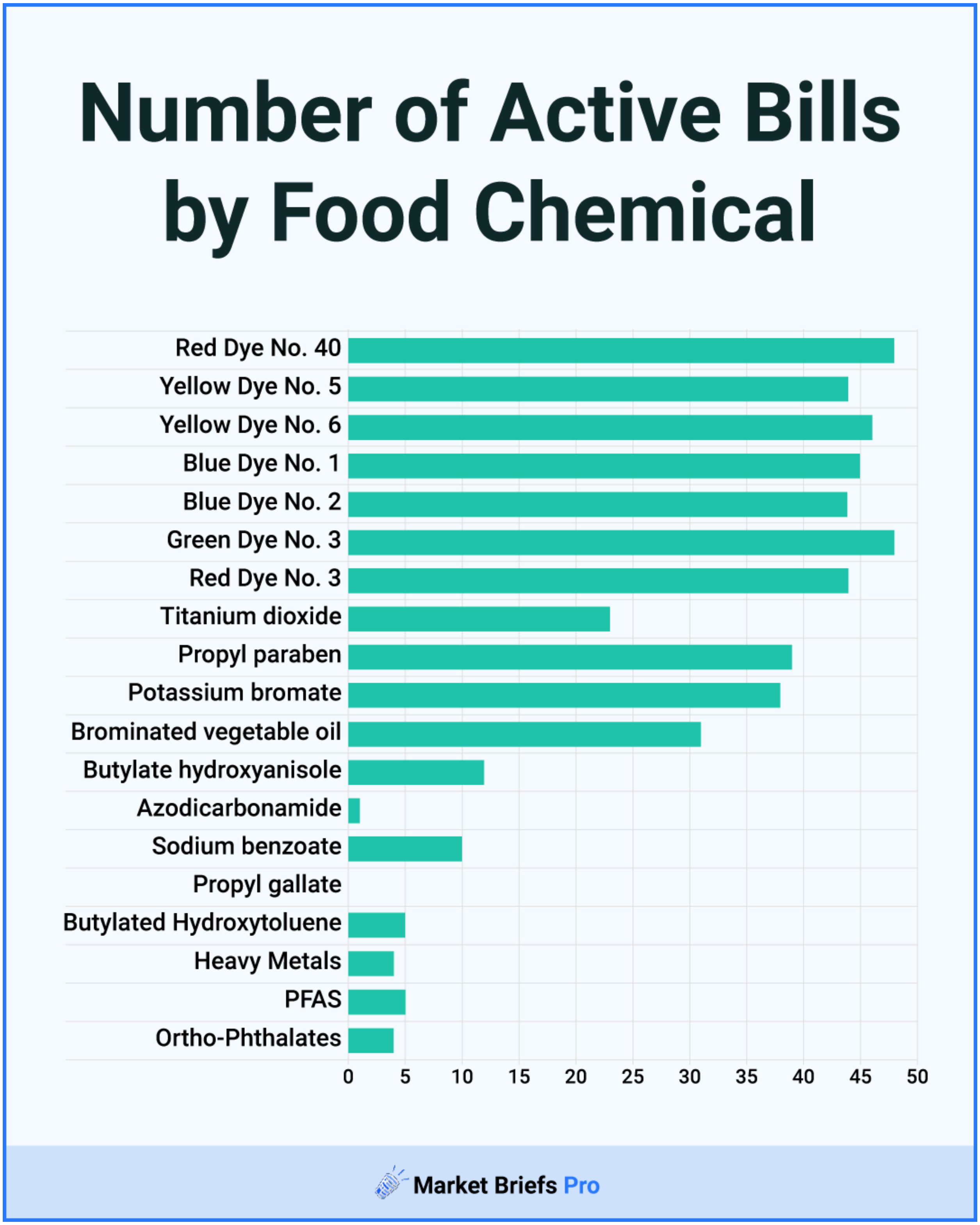
These developments have created new investment opportunities in what we have identified as a Broad Market shift:

Federal and consumer support for natural ingredients, seed-free alternatives, and superfoods, is causing businesses to shift their spending in the food industry.

But how do all of these events relate?

RFK Jr. has been a big promoter of chemical free foods and seed-free alternatives - boasting the potential health benefits.

And as the Head of the Department of Health and Human Services, he’s started to make an impact on the food industry.

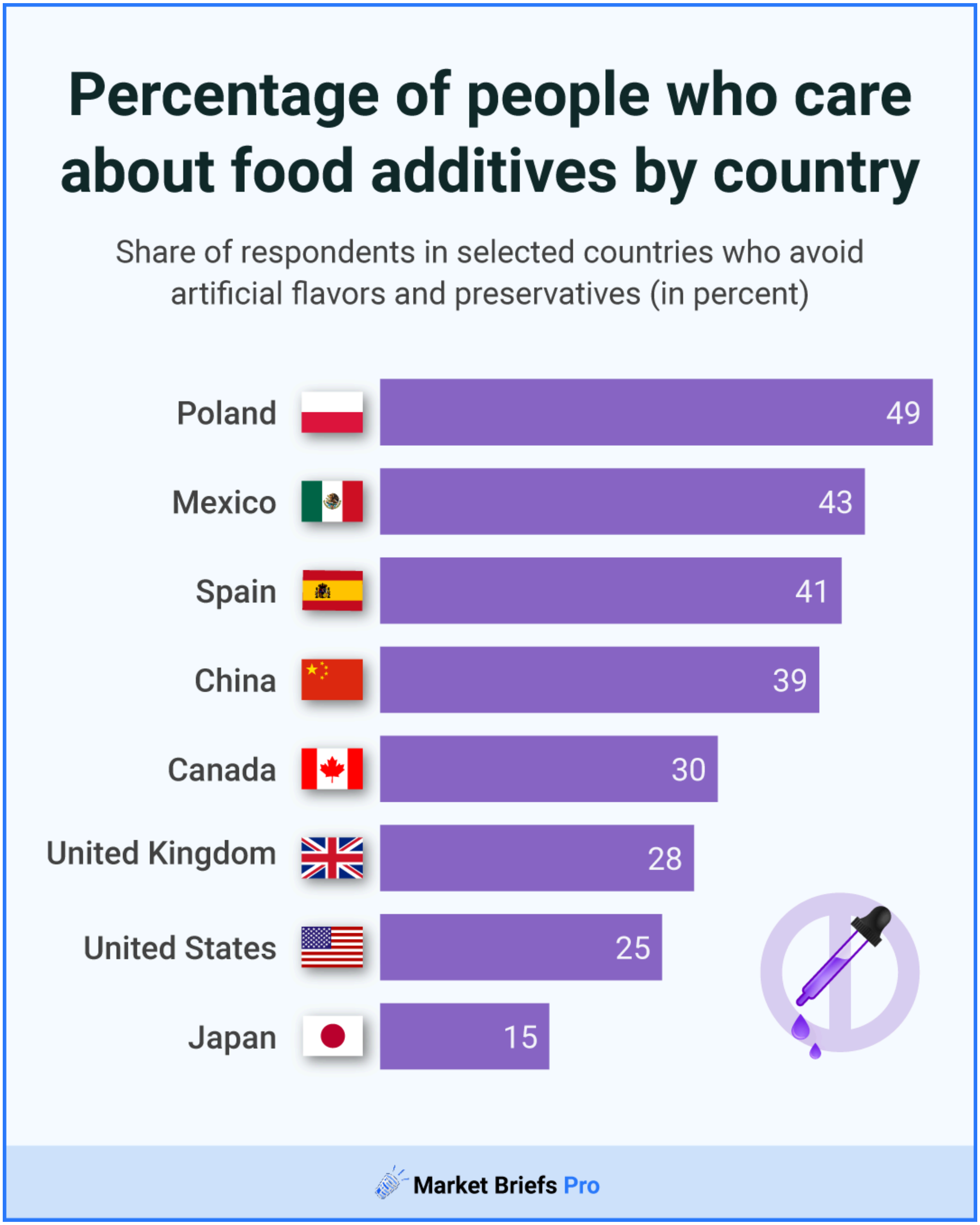


Data via The Food Institute

- RFK Jr. has directed the FDA to begin phasing out 8 common chemical dyes in our food, including Red 40.

This shift is fairly new at the federal level, but consumers have been interested in foods that have “clean labels”, or foods with simple ingredients and no added chemicals, for years now.

- 25% of consumers avoid foods with added chemicals, according to Statista.



Data via Statista

We've said it before and we'll say it again - *we're not doctors.*

We just track investment opportunities. And there is a shift developing with how our food is made.

How do we know? We gathered our own research and polled our Market Briefs readers, putting together an exclusive dataset just for you.

- 80% of those polled said they are actively trying to cut artificial dyes or chemicals from their diet.

So we hope you're hungry - because we're about to dig into how this food industry shift is creating opportunities for several businesses to profit.

We dug deeper into the data: Check out our deep dive and further breakdown of this shift.*

NATURAL FOOD

The Clean Label Boom

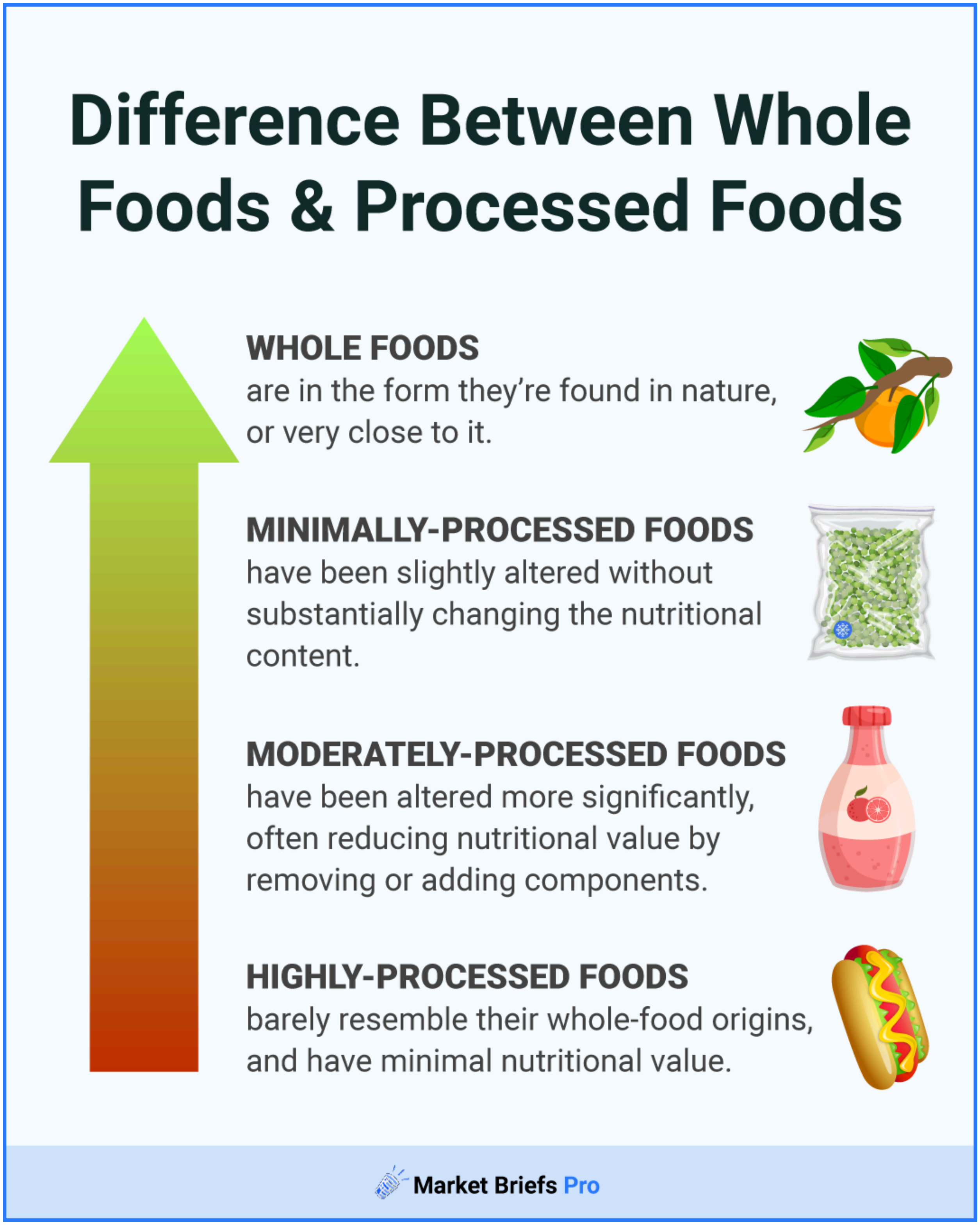
Almost 75% of Americans are now interested in incorporating whole foods into their everyday diets, according to the Whole Grains Council.

What's that? These are foods that are found in nature and are sold as close as possible to their original form.

In short - from farm to table, they typically contain no added chemicals.

In our exclusive poll, 44% of respondents said they would be more likely to buy a product with a clean label, or one with no added ingredients.

The Make America Healthy Again initiative seeks to reduce the amount of processing that goes into our foods, aiming to make our food as close as possible to its natural state.



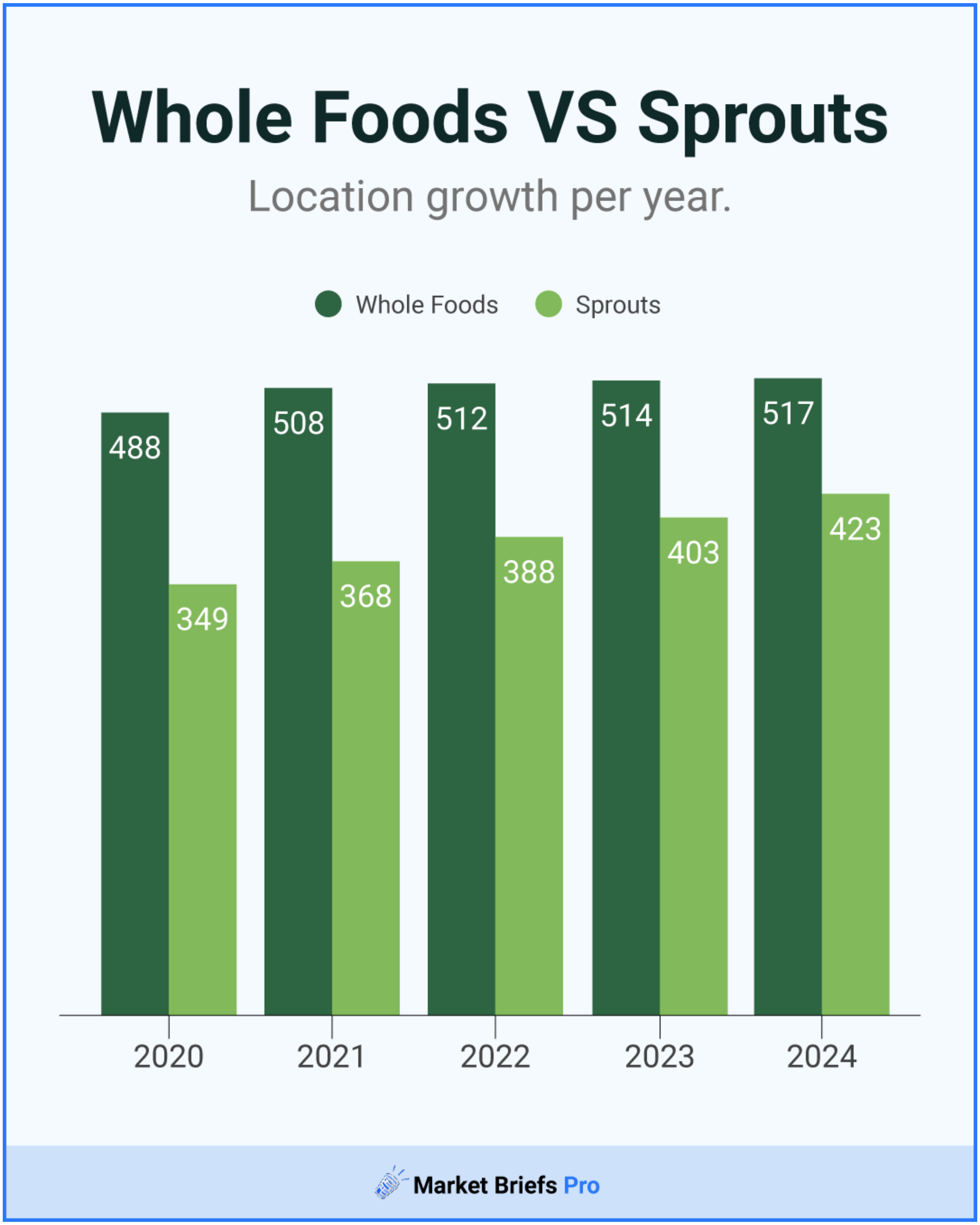
Data via Bodzii

Whether this is good or bad for our health is not for us to say - but there have been some businesses that have seen their revenues rise as this shift has developed.

The first is Sprouts Farmers Market (SFM), one of the fastest-growing grocery chains in the U.S.

- The chain has opened 75 new locations since 2020. Its largest competitor, Whole Foods (owned by Amazon) has only opened 29 new locations.

The chain focuses on natural and organic food options and caters to shoppers in 23 states.



Data [via](#) Sites USA

What sets it apart? The company says that 90% of its products are free of artificial flavors, food coloring, preservatives, and synthetic ingredients.

That's allowed it to capitalize on this shift towards natural ingredients - it increased its overall revenue by almost $1 billion in 2024 from $6.8 to $7.7 billion.

A recent Gallup poll showed that 83% of Americans prefer to buy locally sourced and produced food as well.

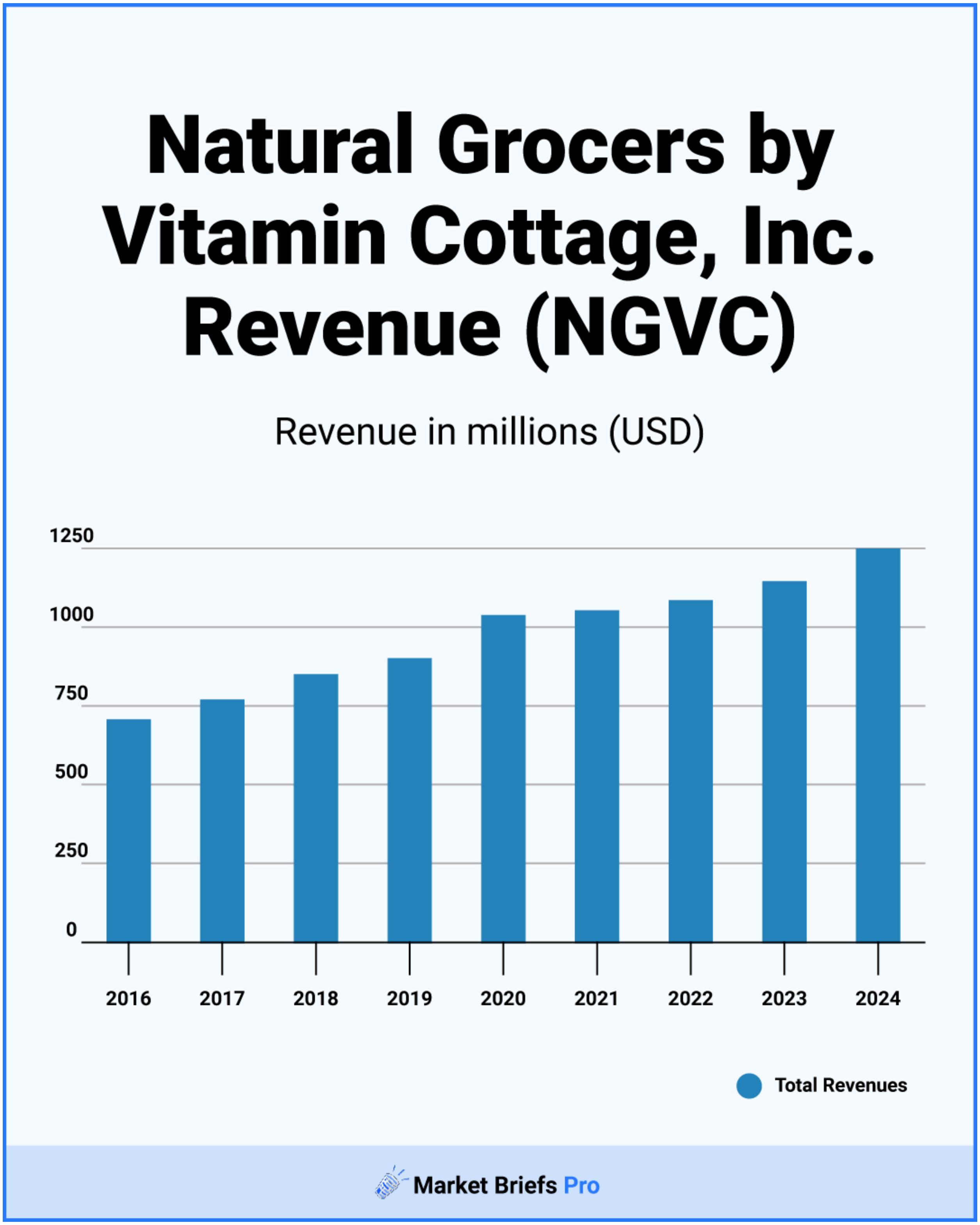
Data via Yahoo! Finance

Each Sprouts location offers food sourced from that store's region, with thousands of private businesses represented.

Natural Grocers by Vitamin Cottage (NGVC) is another food chain that focuses on natural ingredients, but also sells supplements and vitamins.

- The chain also has a heavy focus on educating shoppers about its products and the use cases for them.

Natural Grocers by Vitamin Cottage launched its IPO in 2012 and has been a hit ever since - the company now has 162 locations nationwide.



Data [via](#) company 10-K

The reason for its success lies in the fact that it sells what it calls “unconventional food products”.

And while medications are still essential, Deloitte found that 76% of Americans would rather maintain a healthy diet than take medicine.

This idea has also been supported at the federal level by RFK Jr. - who may influence businesses through policies at the FDA or HHS.

Regardless of whether it works or not, its products are meeting demand for a large group of Americans, which has translated into more sales.

The company generated $1.2 billion in revenue last year, up from $1.1 billion in 2023.

Natural Grocers by Vitamin Cottage plans on opening 3-4 more locations in 2025.

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

SEED FREE

The Great Oil Swap

RFK Jr. has been vocally opposed to seed oils and seed-based products since taking over as head of the Department of Health and Human Services.

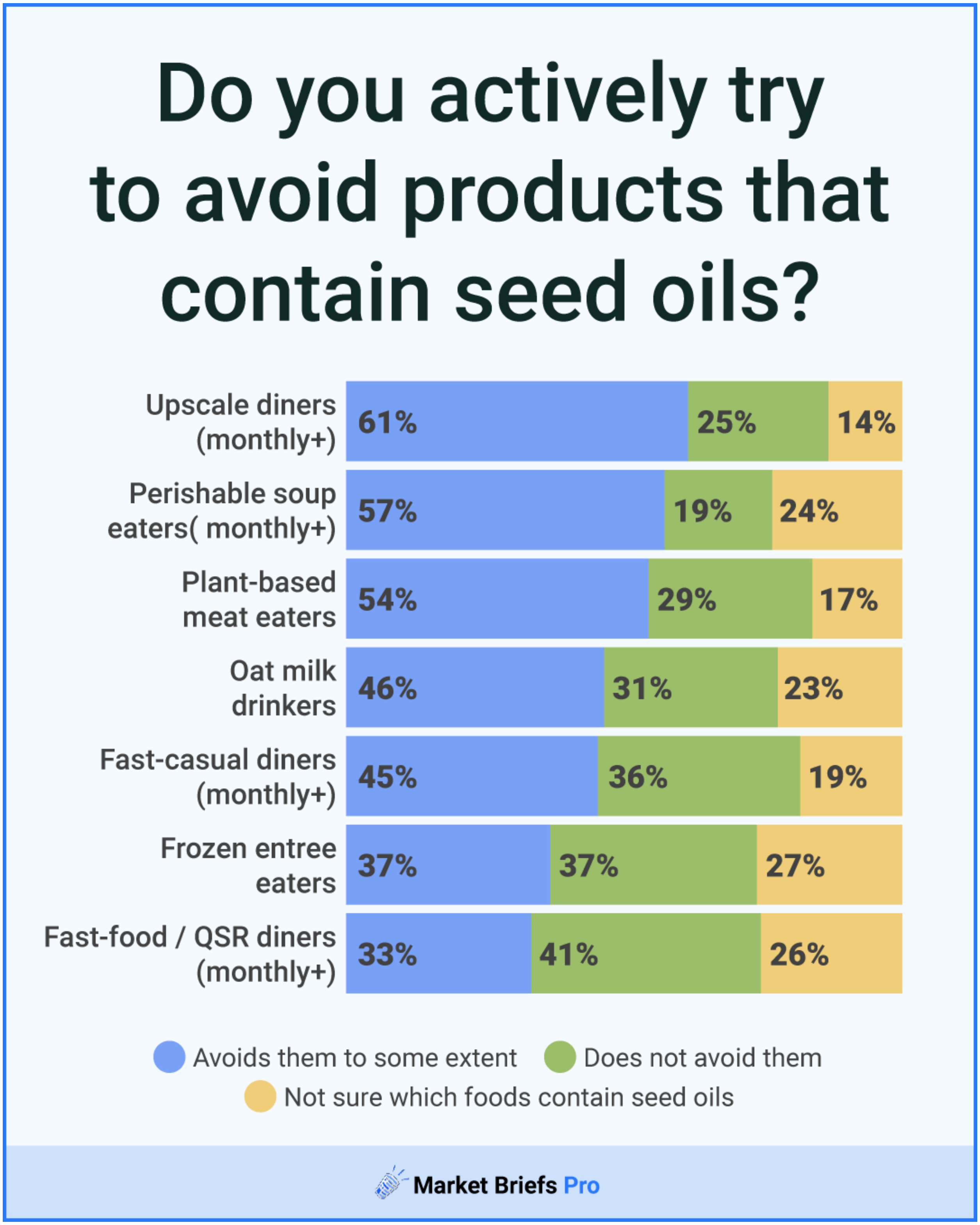
Why? Some studies have shown that seed oils can create inflammation in our bodies, leading to negative health effects.

For full transparency - the jury is still out on whether they do or not.

However, many Americans think avoiding seed oils is better for their health, which is contributing to this shift.

That’s pushed many people to push back against seed oils - with 28% actively avoiding them, according to the American Heart Association.

WiseCode estimates that just over a third of our food in the U.S. contains seed oils.



Data via Civic Science

Many consumers are now looking for alternatives to seed oils and the companies that are producing those alternatives are seeing a rise in revenue.

One of those companies is Restaurant Brands International (QSR).

It’s the owner of brands like Popeyes, Burger King, and Tim Hortons - those businesses are experimenting with alternatives to seed oils.

For instance, Popeyes has used beef tallow to cook its food for years. Burger King cut seed oils from its menu over a decade ago.

Data [via](via) company 10-K

The result? Restaurant Brands International increased its revenue by $1.4 billion in 2024, up from just over $7 billion in 2023.

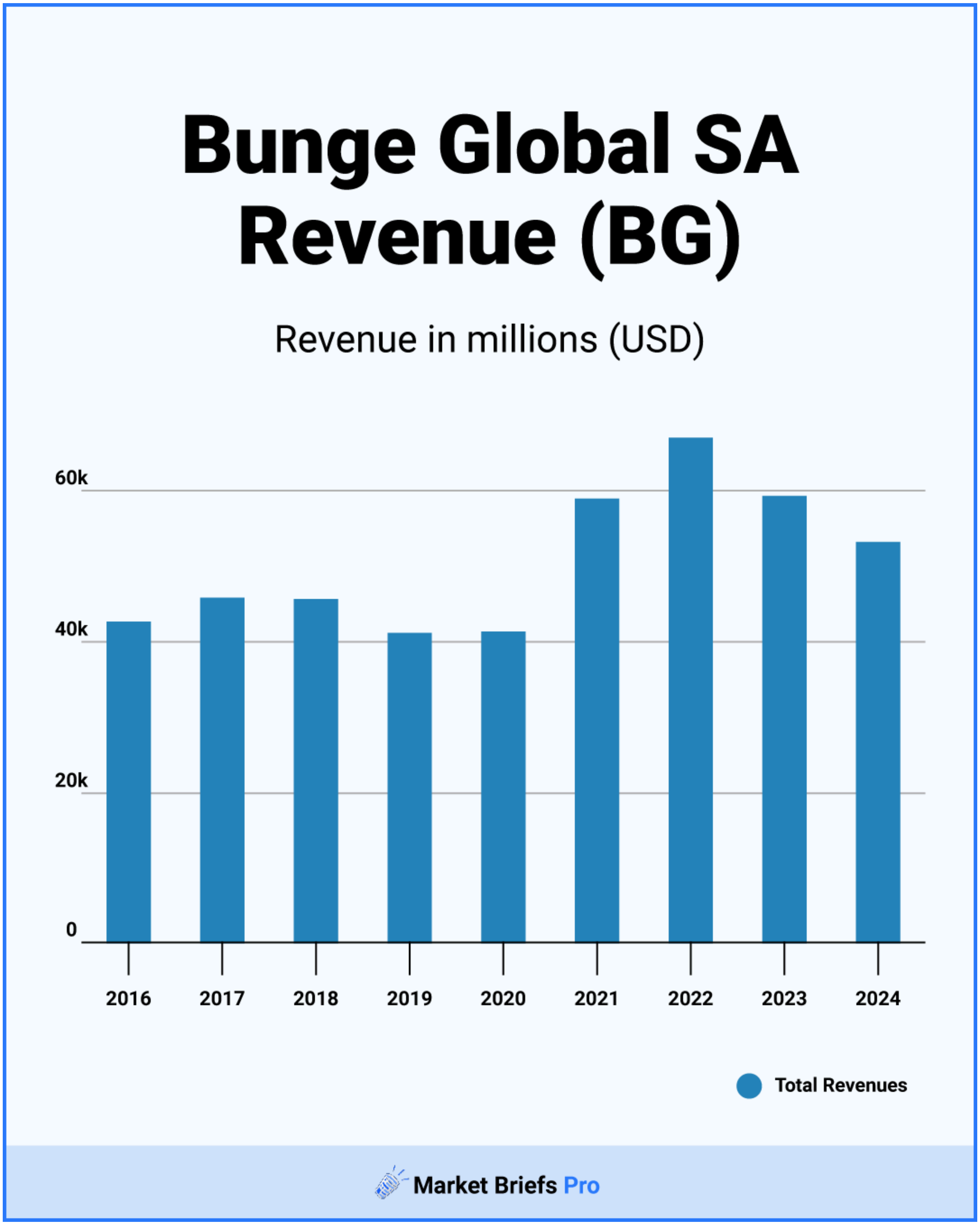
- Shares of the company are also up over 7% in just the last six months. The S&P 500 is up by only 5% in the last six months.

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

These chains simply make food with seed oils or seed oil alternatives - but who actually makes the oils themselves?

Bunge Limited (BG) is one of the largest producers of food oils in the world, generating over 22% of the entire market's total revenue.

The company offers a wide variety of seed oil alternatives to businesses and consumers, like non-GMO canola oils through its subsidiary, Whole Harvest.



Data via company 10-K

Why does that matter? Just like the other companies in this report, *Bunge is simply meeting demand.*

No matter what oil consumers or businesses are interested in, Bunge wants to be the main company offering it.

That puts them in a position to profit as this shift continues. It earned $53 billion in revenue in 2024, which was a decrease from $59 billion in 2023.

Why the drop? Droughts and diseases damaged crops last year, limiting the amount Bunge could sell.

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

However, the company is addressing these issues by moving its farming operations to new locations, which costs money today, but may put it in a better position to profit in the future.

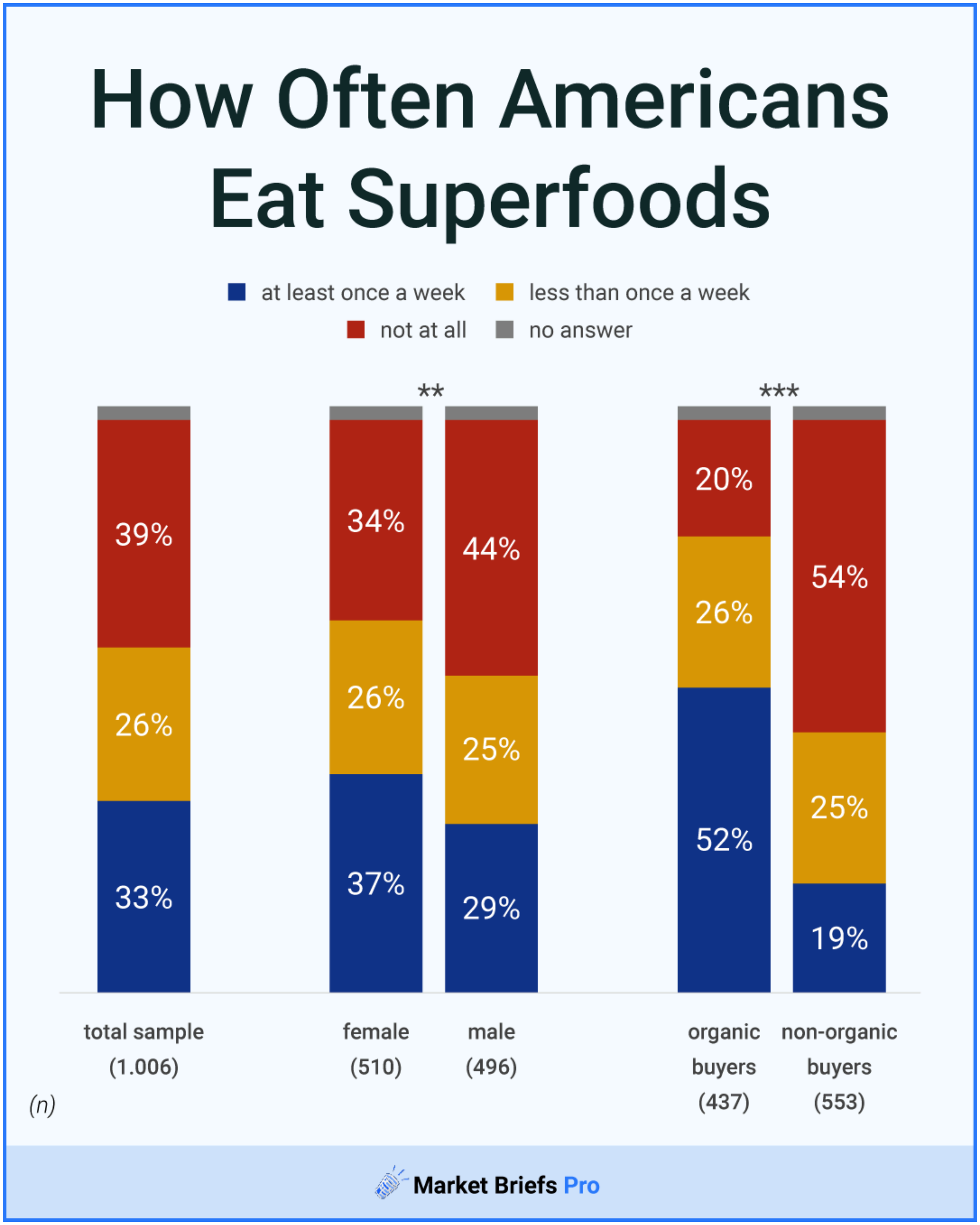
SUPERFOODS

Food With Superpowers

Superfoods are foods that provide several of the nutrients our bodies need, all in one food.

Companies are now marketing some of their processed foods as superfoods, simply because they use all natural ingredients.

Has it worked? A study from the University of Spain found that Americans find processed superfoods healthy, simply due to their perception of the potential health benefits.



Data [via](#) MDPI

That’s appealing to consumers. A recent study from Beverage Daily found that 65% of people want more functionality out of their food, meaning they want it to do more than just taste good.

- 30% of the Briefers we polled in our survey said they buy a food product that promotes its multiple health benefits.

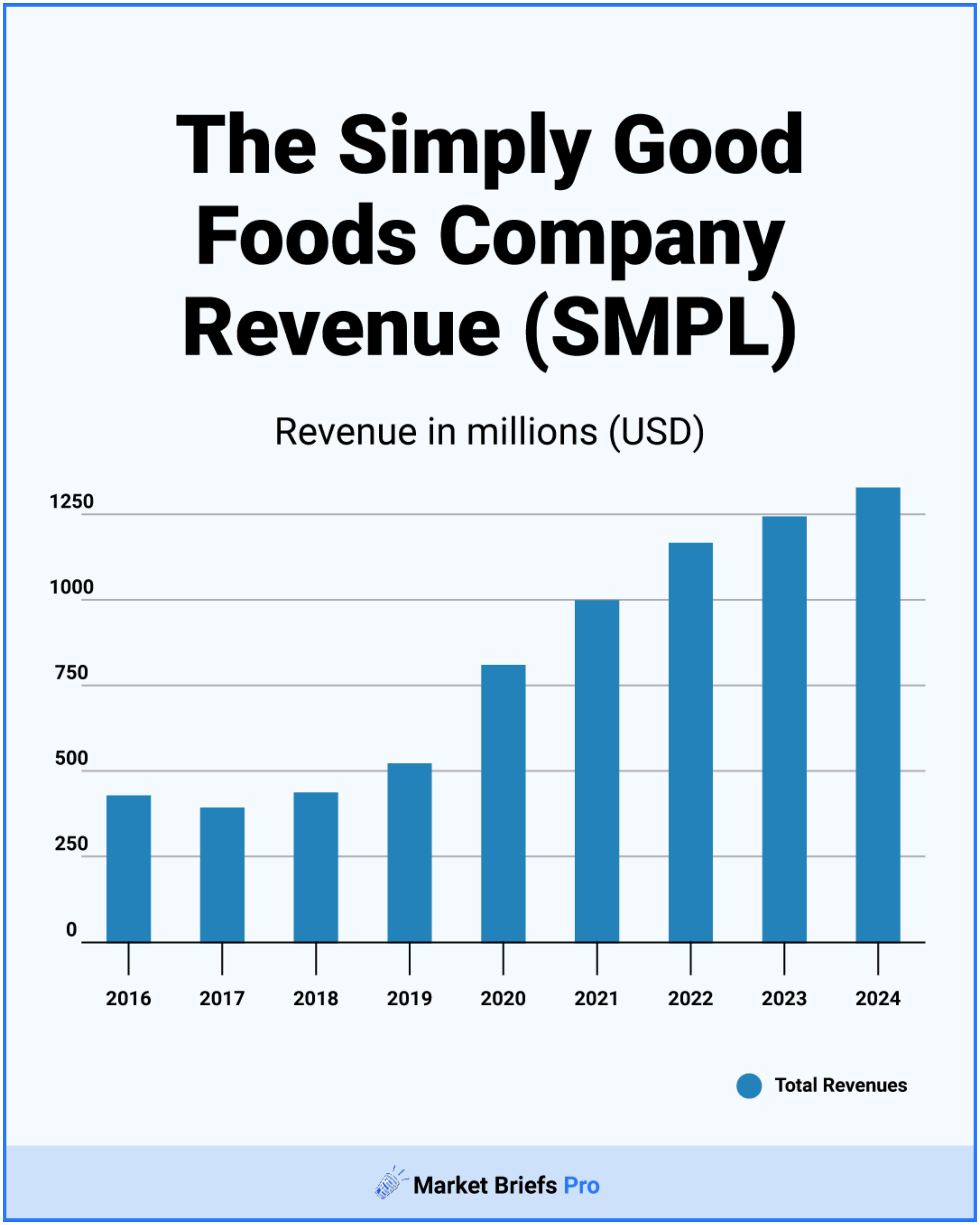
The Simply Good Foods Company (SMPL) is producing superfoods and claims its food has multiple health benefits.

Simply Good Foods owns brands like Atkins, Quest, and SimplyProtein - all of which are promoted to contain low sugar, low carbs, and high protein.

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- In 2023, sales for Quest bars on Amazon jumped up by 23% year-over-year and 75% of all sports nutrition bars sold last year were Quest bars, according to Leveling Up.

Natural foods have really helped them stand out as well - they acquired OWYN last year which specializes in plant-based, allergen-free, ready-to-drink protein shakes, for $280 million.



Data via company 10-K

The superfood and natural food shift has allowed the company to benefit financially overall, as the company earned a record $1.3 billion in revenue last year.

Simply Good Foods focuses mainly on nutritionally rich foods you can eat, BellRing Brands (BRBR) does the same thing, but in the high-nutrition drink space.

BellRing Brands has created a line of ready-to-drink protein shakes, owning brands like Premier Protein and Dymatize.

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

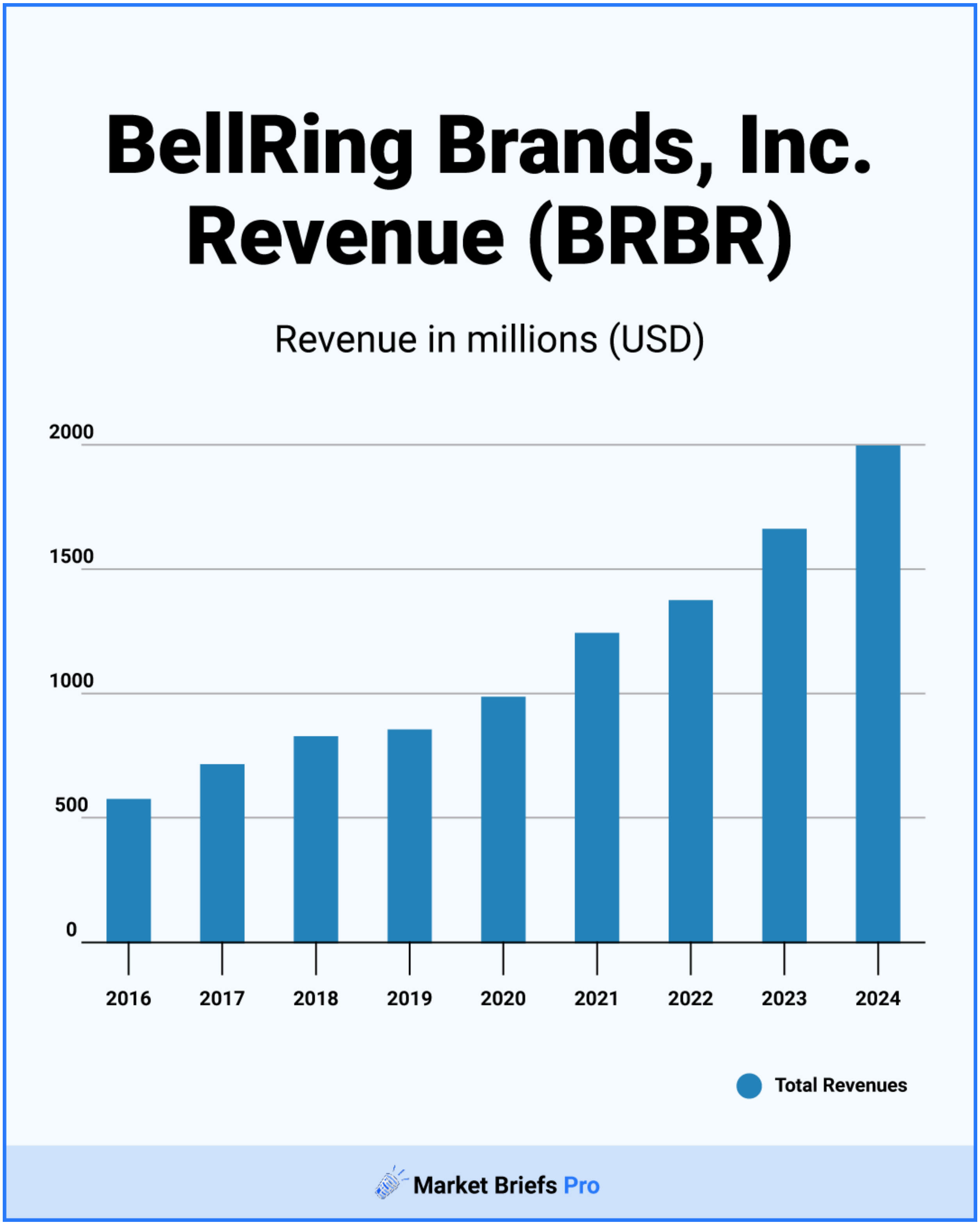
And even though they're drinks, they still fall under the superfoods umbrella.

Why? BellRing advertises these products as being nutritionally rich and no other company is bigger in the superfoods drink space.

- S&P Global estimates that BellRing holds 21% of the protein shake market as of 2025, up from 19% in 2024.

Its market share is growing because demand is growing. Sales for its nutritionally rich drinks grew 10% in 2023 and 14% in 2024.

That led to an increase in revenue for BellRing Brands, with the company earning a record $1.9 billion in revenue in 2024, an increase from $1.6 billion in 2023.



Data [via](#) company 10-K

RISKS

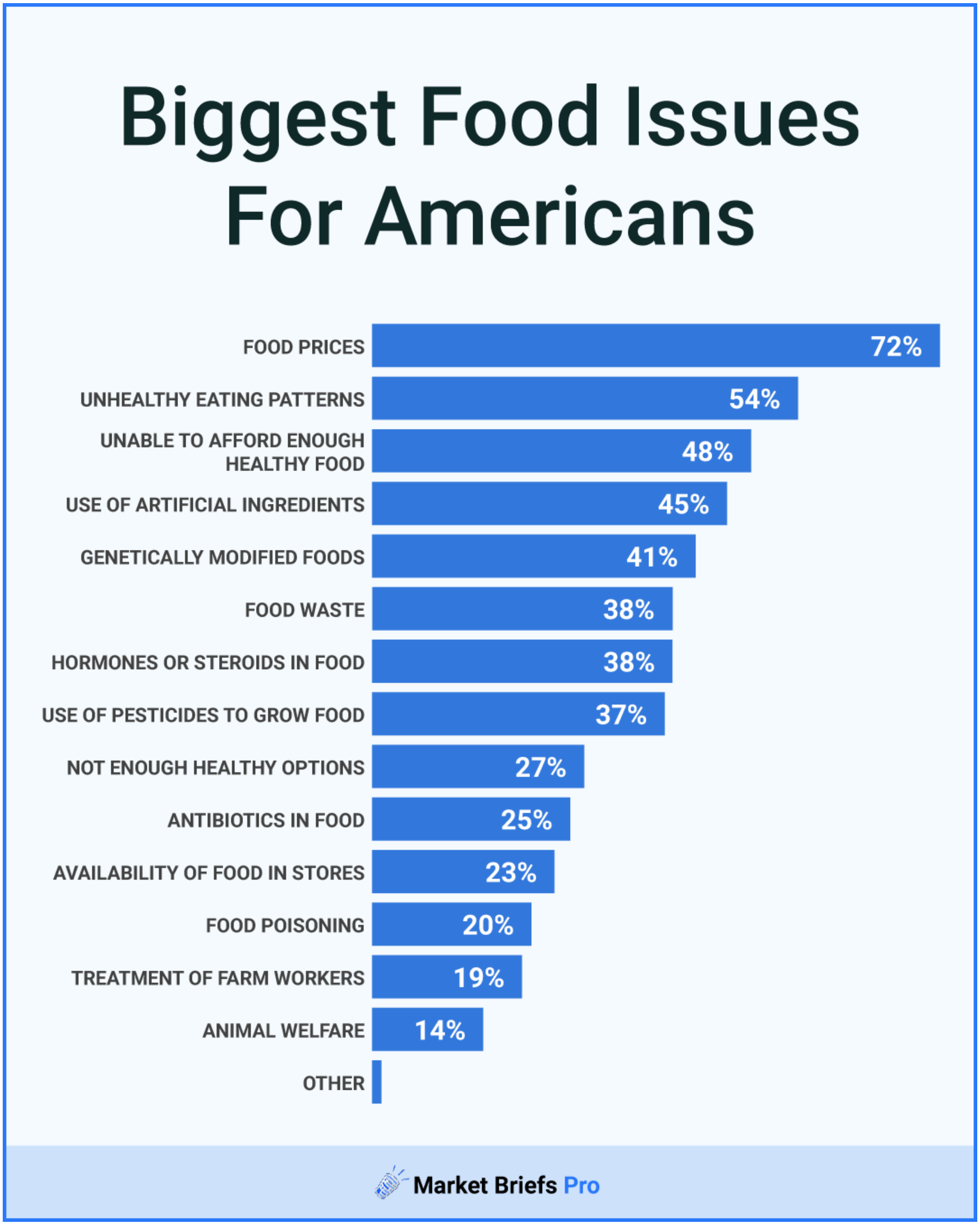
The Food Fine Print

One of the biggest risks to investors in the food space is business risk.

Companies that make certain foods may not innovate over time, which could mean they make less money.

- Plus, natural foods could end up being a short-lived trend and consumers and our government could change their minds about what they want in the future.

Not to mention, natural foods typically cost more to produce than processed foods, which makes them more expensive to buy.



Data via Research America

If our economy slows down, people could reduce their spending on these types of foods and instead buy cheaper processed foods.

Lastly, natural foods are more subject to weather risks than other types of foods - even shelf stable foods, which require natural ingredients to create.

Droughts, plant diseases, bug infestations all impact the viability of natural foods and can sometimes lead to less food being produced, or even recalls.

All of that can make it difficult for natural food companies to sustain profits, which could hurt investor returns over time.

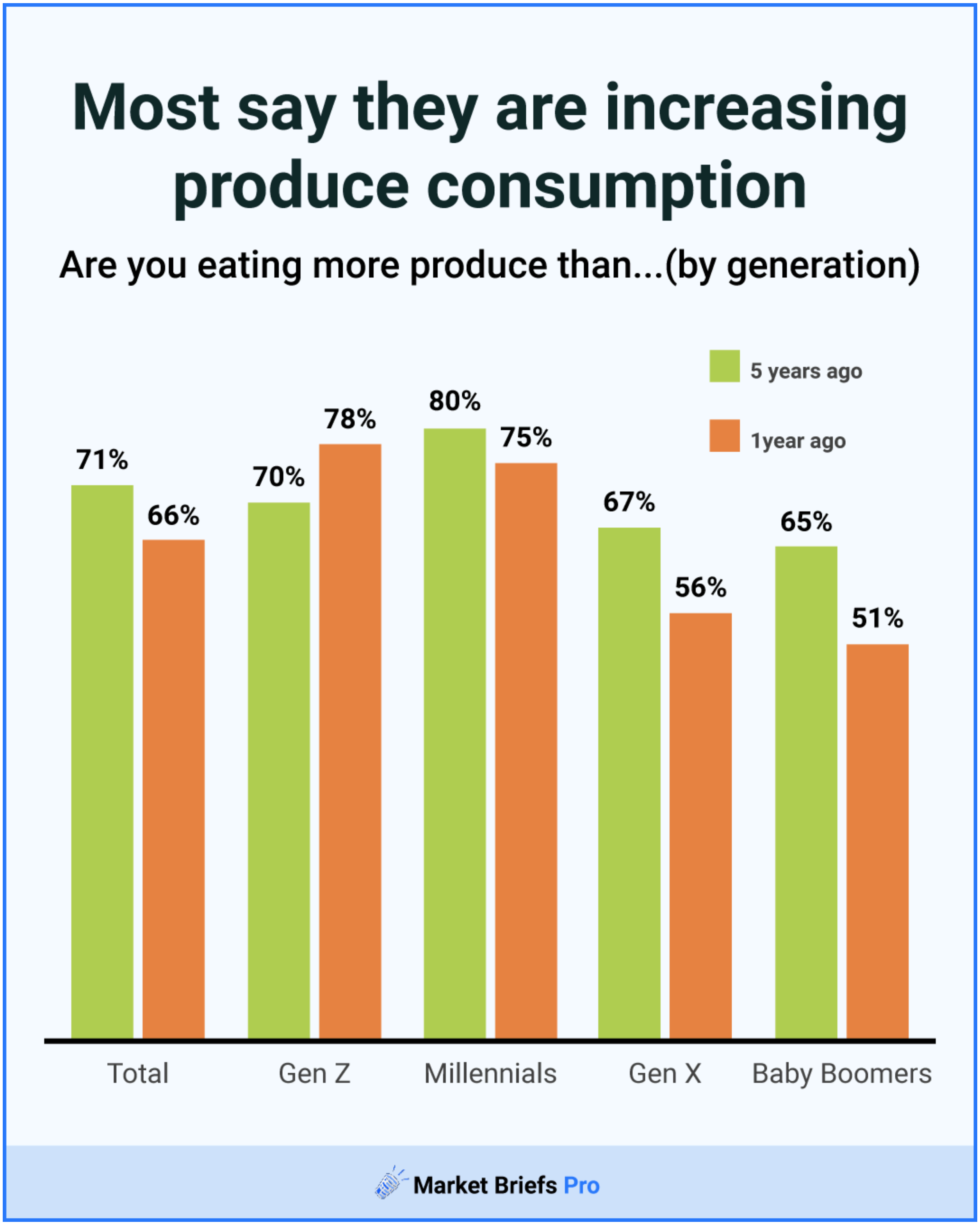
REVIEW

Where Food is Headed Next

While companies are still producing foods with added sugars and other chemical additives, we are at the forefront of a Broad Market shift right now.

And the bottom line is: More consumers are turning to natural foods and superfoods right now with clean labels over processed foods with added ingredients.

Briefers we polled in our exclusive survey reflect this - with almost 50% saying they are more likely to buy food that has a clean label.



Data [via](#) The Packer

RFK Jr. being appointed as the Head of the Department of Health and Human Services has accelerated this shift through policy.

Businesses are now shifting their spending to align more with what consumers and our federal government wants, which is creating opportunities for investors to profit.

- Briefs Media Team

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